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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

For my extended essay I chose to focus on ambivalent sexism as portrayed through the characterization of females in James Bond's film Skyfall. I chose this film, because I felt that it had a clear link to the local manifestation of sexism in Britain, especially seen through the character of Moneypenny. Moneypenny embodies the sexist British stereotype of a secretary, which is evident in British culture and media, strengthening the local significance of ambivalent sexism in Britain. I found that many cases of sexism in Skyfall are difficult to notice because they have become more nuanced, with characters embodying sexist stereotypes instead of being subject to explicit sexism. This is especially apparent in the character of M, who is typically never associated with sexism, but still embodies theories of benevolent sexism. In addition, I needed to further refine the analysis of Moneypenny in order to make my local significance of sexism in Britain clear.

As a woman who has personally faced sexist attitudes, I struggled with objectively presenting information on how sexism is reinforced in Skyfall because the analysis is based on my own interpretations, which may be biassed. The further understanding of nuanced sexism in media has affected the way I interact with all media, as I am now able to spot subtle and benevolent sexism. As media is a reflection of societal norms, the ambivalent sexism that permeates film has led me to realise how ingrained sexism is in society.

At the end of completing this essay, I have gained a new understanding of how interdisciplinary research is especially important for my future, as many societal problems are extremely complex and need to be studied from varying perspectives. Throughout the project, I have worked largely independently and engaged in my research with passion and sustained personal interest in my topic. My understanding of English analysis has deepened, as in the future I will be able to focus on larger authorial choices such as the lack of characters, which, in Skyfall, is seen as the omission of female characters after their role is fulfilled. I overcame several difficulties with meeting some of the criteria, but I kept resilient and showed determination and responsibility for my own work. In that way I was able to reach a good end product and I am satisfied with the outcome of my essay.

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